

Max Pienkny

Department of Economics
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Fields of Interest

Applied Microeconomics; Health Economics; Political Economy; Industrial Organization

EDUCATION

Northwestern University <i>Ph.D. in Economics (expected 2027)</i>	2021–present
Stanford University <i>B.A. in Economics (with Honors)</i>	2015–2019

WORKING PAPERS

“From the Dial to the Aisle: The Effects of Talk Radio”

“Churches and Local Economies” (with Zane Kashner)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

“Understanding the Short- and Long-Term Impacts of School-Based Health Centers” (with Marika Cabral, Bokyoung Kim, Adrienne Sabety, Maya Rossin-Slater, Molly Schnell, and Hannes Schwandt)

“Learning-by-Doing versus Training-Cohort in Medical Decision-Making” (with Claire Boone and Molly Schnell)

“Making an Echo Chamber: Selection and Persuasion in Ideological Segregation Online”

“When Protection Kills: Footprint-Based Regulation, Vehicle Upsizing, and U.S. Motor-Vehicle Fatalities”

JOURNAL ARTICLES

Pienkny, M., M. Rossin-Slater, M. Schnell, and H. Schwandt (2024). “The Lasting Impacts of School Shootings on Youth Psychotropic Drug Use.” *AEA Papers and Proceedings*, 114: 387–393.

EXPERIENCE

Northwestern University <i>Research Assistant for Prof. Molly Schnell</i>	2023–present <i>Evanston, IL</i>
Northwestern University <i>Research Assistant for Prof. Bernard Black</i>	2022 <i>Evanston, IL</i>
Opportunity Insights at Harvard University <i>Pre-doctoral fellow for Profs. Raj Chetty, John Friedman, and Nathaniel Hendren</i>	2019–2021 <i>Cambridge, MA</i>
Economic Policy Research Center <i>Economic Researcher</i>	2018 <i>Tbilisi, Georgia</i>

TEACHING

Teaching Assistant, ECON 307 – Economics of Medical Care (Winter 2025), Northwestern University (Instructor: Molly Schnell)

CTEC evaluation metrics (TA):

- Average overall TA rating 5.93/6; Median 6/6

HONORS, FELLOWSHIPS, AND AWARDS

National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship <i>National Science Foundation</i>	2021–2026
Robert Eisner Graduate Fellowship <i>Department of Economics, Northwestern University</i> Awarded for excellence in research and teaching	2025–2026
Susan Schmidt Bies Prize <i>Department of Economics, Northwestern University</i> Awarded for best 3rd-year research paper	2024
Anna Laura Myers Prize for Outstanding Honors Thesis <i>Department of Economics, Stanford University</i>	2019

CONFERENCE AND SEMINAR PRESENTATIONS

AEA Annual Meeting (ASSA) — “Understanding the Short- and Long-Term Impacts of School-Based Health Centers” (with Marika Cabral, Bokyoung Kim, Adrienne Sabety, Maya Rossin-Slater, Molly Schnell, and Hannes Schwandt)	Jan 2026 (scheduled)
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DEPARTMENT AND PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

Co-organizer of Northwestern's Applied Microeconomics Lunch Seminar

2023–2024

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Programming Skills Stata, R, Python, Julia

Last updated: November 7, 2025